



IAESTE

DIGEST

Shaping the future of youth since 1948



IAESTE Digest

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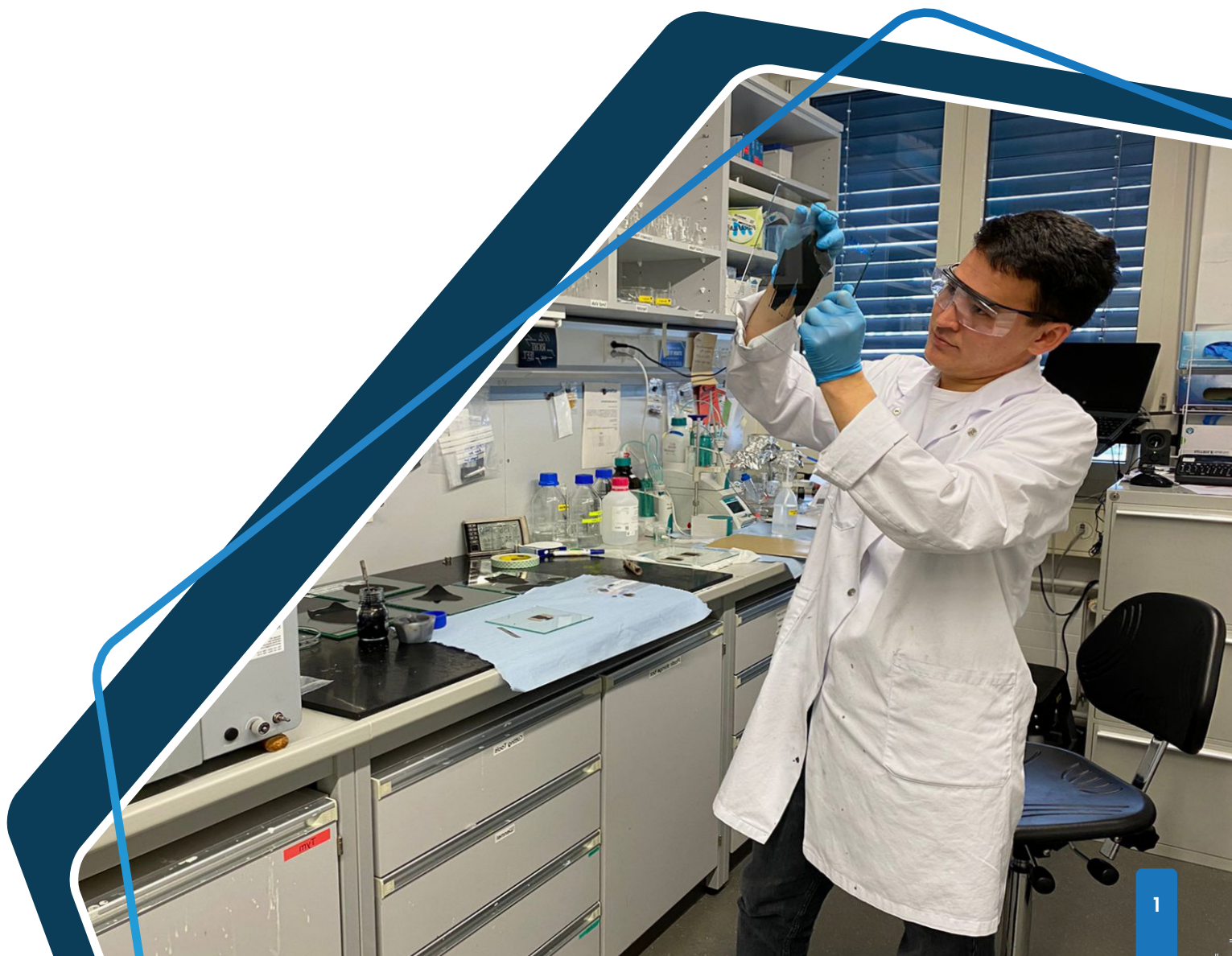
IAESTE is very grateful to everyone who has provided content for this publication.

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**Work.
Experience.
Discover.**



IAESTE





Building friendships, connections and understanding

Since its inception, IAESTE has championed the exchange of ideas and experience. By enabling young people to take internships in other countries, IAESTE has helped build friendships, connections and understanding worldwide.

At a time of great uncertainty in the international community, IAESTE's work is more necessary than ever. Multilateralism must be strengthened so we can overcome our many common challenges and build a world of peace, prosperity, dignity and opportunity for all people on a healthy planet.

Words of the Secretary-General of the United Nations
António Guterres



SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT GOALS

ngo-unesco
liaison committee

IAESTE supports the United Nations' efforts in line with the Sustainable Development Goals (SDG), specifically SDG 4 - Quality Education

We are delighted to present the IAESTE Digest

a publication dedicated to our global network
of supporters, partners, and stakeholders.

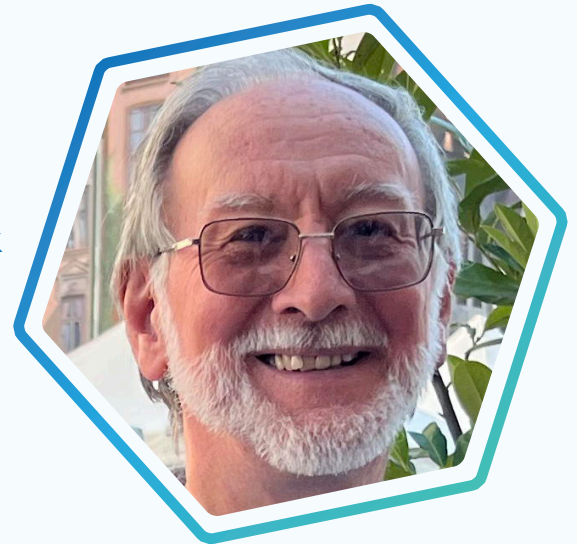
What began in the 1930s as an idea by James Newby, the Superintendent of Vacation Studies at Imperial College London, became a global success with IAESTE's official establishment in 1948. Since then, our programme has transformed the lives of hundreds of thousands of students across the globe by providing international internships that foster professional growth and cross-cultural exchange.

Our success is due to the straightforward and affordable process refined over the course of nearly 80 years that includes four strategic pillars: students, academia, companies and governments. This partnership managed by our affiliate members in more than 90 nations provides professional development opportunities for students and recent graduates; allows universities to expand their curriculum; grows a diverse, capable talent pool for companies; and spotlights public diplomacy efforts to support government initiatives.

Our mission to operate a high-quality global internship program that promotes international understanding is just as important now as it was when IAESTE was founded. As an NGO with Consultative Status at the United Nations, the efforts of our members directly contribute to the UN Sustainable Development Goals by expanding access to quality technical experiential education throughout our network.

This IAESTE Digest both introduces you to international internships and gives a voice to the community we serve. We hope the experiences of our network inspire and motivate you to become a part of this amazing story.

Students, universities, potential host companies, and government offices can reach out to the IAESTE Global Headquarters, or to the affiliate IAESTE office in their home country to identify ways to become part of our global internship experience that offers life-changing experiences to students from across the globe. Join us!



Words of the IAESTE President

Bernard Baeyens

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to read 'Baeyens'.

IAESTE at a glance

International Association for the Exchange of Students for Technical Experience (IAESTE) is a global non-governmental, non-profit organisation with consultative status at the United Nations Economic and Social Council (ECOSOC) and UNESCO, and is affiliated with the UN Department of Public Information (DPI).

IAESTE was founded after World War II to promote international understanding and cooperation.

We benefit students, employers and universities through the IAESTE internship programme. Paid internships abroad help students gain professional experience and cross-cultural skills. Employers and universities gain access to talented international interns, who bring new ideas and insights to their business or research.

IAESTE provides primarily STEM internships, however this also expands to other fields, such as marketing, management and languages.



IAESTE values



Trust



Commitment



Diversity



Growth



Friendship



90+
IAESTE offices

160+
nationalities

IAESTE administers its internship programmes through a network of offices in more than 90 countries worldwide.

IAESTE strives to make the internship programme as accessible as possible. In 2021, we started serving students from countries without IAESTE presence and introduced remote internships. As a result, we are proud to provide internships to students of more than 160 nationalities.



IAESTE Internship Programmes

IAESTE provides three different internship programmes tailored to students' and employers' needs.



Exchange Internship

- **Year-round opportunities** - IAESTE offers students the flexibility to apply for Exchange Internships at any time throughout the year. However, it's worth noting that the latest internships are typically published in November, January, and April.
- **Exclusive to member countries** - These internships are exclusively available to students from IAESTE member countries, fostering a network of opportunities.
- **Enhanced acceptance chances** - When students apply for an Exchange Internship, they benefit from a distinct advantage: competition is limited to applicants within their own country. If selected, their application is the only one forwarded to the employer on a global scale.
- **One application at a time** - Choosing the Exchange Internship programme means students can apply for one internship at a time. Rest assured that their application will receive the attention it deserves. Employers get carefully selected and committed candidates.

IAESTE Internship Programmes



Global Internship

- **A world of choices** - IAESTE's Global Internship programme opens up a world of opportunities, providing students with a diverse array of options to choose from throughout the year.
- **Year-round application** - Students can apply for Global Internships at any time throughout the year, giving them the flexibility to plan their international experience.
- **Open to all countries** - These internships are accessible to students from all countries, creating a global platform for talent exchange and cultural exploration.
- **Wide selection, global competition** - While the selection of internships is more extensive, it's important to note that there's also increased competition. Students from all corners of the world apply for these internships, making it a truly global endeavour.
- **Apply for 2 internships** - As part of the Global Internship programme, students have the option to apply for two internships at the same time, as long as the two internships are located in different countries.



IAESTE Internship Programmes

Reserved Internship

- **Tailored for specific students and employers** - Reserved Internships are pre-arranged opportunities specifically matched to a particular student with a specific employer. In this case, the IAESTE office in the student's country is not directly involved in the selection of the student.
- **Complementary support** - This programme is not part of the core IAESTE exchange, but offers an invaluable option to provide support to students who have already secured internships that were not found through IAESTE. It ensures that students receive the necessary assistance and benefits once they've been accepted for such internships.
- **Explore your options** - If students have already made up their minds and have a specific internship in mind, they can consider our Reserved Internship programme.



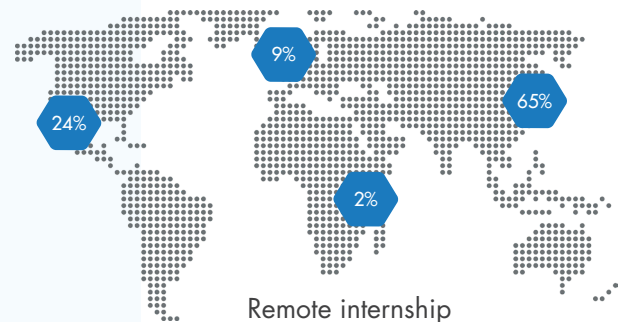
Remote internships

Meaningful work experience from anywhere in the world

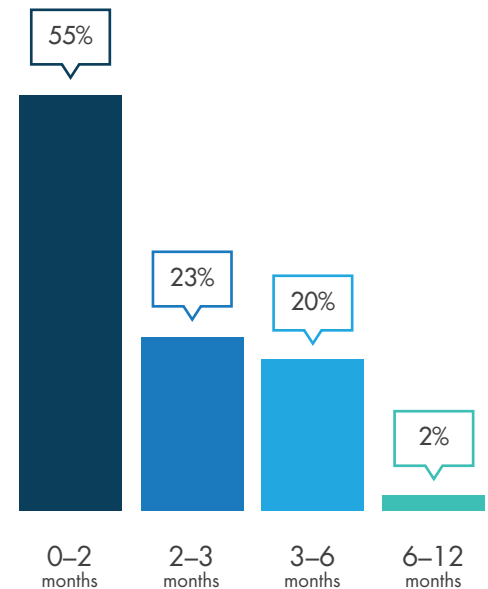
IAESTE remote internships provide students with meaningful work experience, combining high-quality professional development with accessibility and flexibility.

Thanks to the support of IAESTE's global network of offices, companies can strengthen their teams with talented interns from more than 90 countries and 160 nationalities.

IAESTE internships complement students' university education with practical skills. IAESTE supports universities' internationalisation strategies and creates a global network of academic institutions, promoting learning and knowledge transfer.

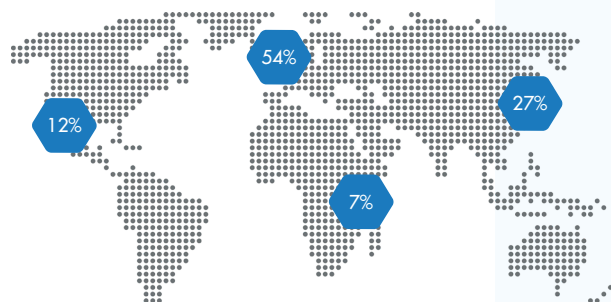


Remote internship sending regions

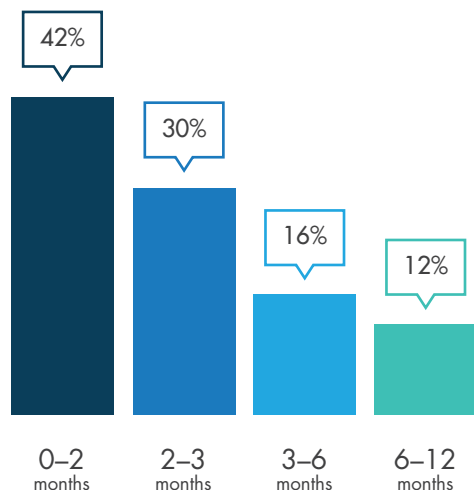


Duration of remote internships

On-site internships



On-site internship destinations



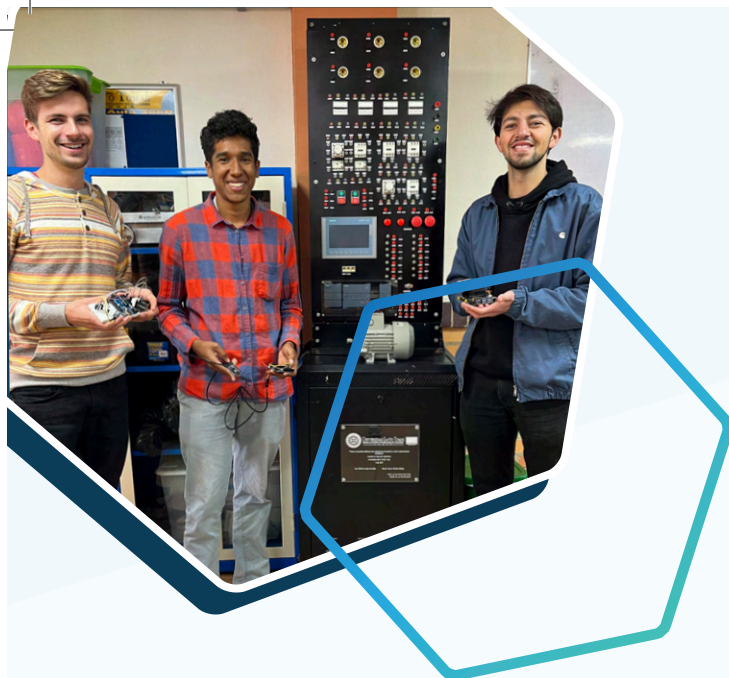
Duration of on-site internships



High-quality professional development in more than 90 countries worldwide

Paid, on-site internships enable students to gain valuable professional experience, live and work abroad, enhance their CVs, find new friendships and broaden their horizons. IAESTE interns solve business and research challenges in real work environments, offer new perspectives to their employers and develop their skills.

Employers benefit from IAESTE's global network of offices, gaining access to students from more than 90 countries and 160 nationalities. IAESTE interns bring unique skills and experience to their employers, as well as enthusiasm and internationalisation.



IAESTE internship programmes in numbers

Overview of students and
internships in the past
5 years: 2020–2024

Top 10 internship fields



Computer Science / Informatics



Mechanical Engineering



Electrical and Electronics Engineering



Chemistry and Chemical Engineering



Biology



Architecture



Civil Engineering



Agriculture



Economics, Business, Management
and Marketing



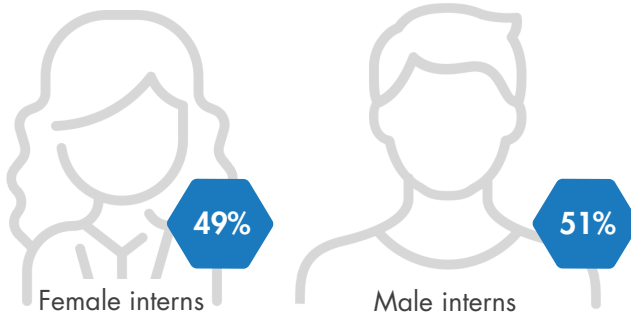
Physics and Physical Sciences

374,000+

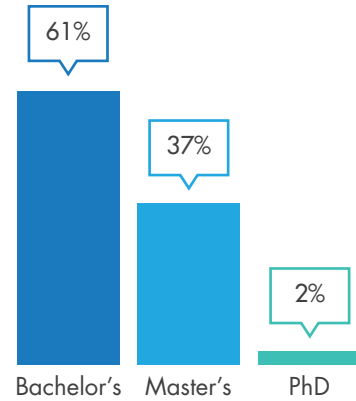
students sent on internships
since 1948

6,200+

students sent on internships
in the past 5 years



Gender balance



Interns' study levels



Interns' nationalities



Interns' average age

IAESTE's journey

Since its foundation in 1948, IAESTE has developed into a modern, global organization. What remains unchanged is our commitment to shape the future of youth and promote international peace and understanding.



1948

Ten countries
establish IAESTE at
Imperial College London

1940–1950



1997

Introduction of the first internal
IT system and creation of the
IAESTE Alumni Network

1991–2000



2005

IAESTE registers in
Luxembourg as a **non-profit
organization** (A.s.b.l.)

2001–2010



1959



IAESTE expands to **Asia, South America** and **Africa** with the help of a **UNESCO grant**

1951–1960

1962



IAESTE gains consultative status with the **UN's Economic and Social Council** strengthening collaboration and partnerships with NGOs and the United Nations

1961–1970

1985



IAESTE provides internships to **200,000** students in the **UN International Youth Year**

1981–1990

1972



First discussions about using **IT tools** to administer internships

1971–1980

2018



Students and employers gain access to IAESTE systems — **the entire internship programme is administered online**

2011–2020

IAESTE makes internships more accessible by introducing **remote internships** and serving **students from non-member countries**

2021



2025



IAESTE welcomes **20 new committees** in the network, **9 from Africa**.

2021–2030

IAESTE interns



Emily's internship in Ghana

Clinical Analysis Laboratory at KNUST

Out of the comfort zone all the way to Ghana!



Germany



Ghana

“

Work

During my internship at the Clinical Analysis Laboratory at KNUST, I primarily worked with blood samples collected from patients to test for various diseases, including malaria, hepatitis B and C, HIV, sickle cell disease, and typhus. The laboratory also housed a microbiology department that specialized in analyzing clinical samples and performing quality checks on food products.

Experience

Ghana is an incredibly beautiful country! One of the first things that struck me was the lush, green landscape. From vast rainforests and stunning coastal beaches to mountainous regions with hiking trails leading to breathtaking waterfalls, the natural beauty is truly awe-inspiring. What's even more remarkable, though, is the vitality and energy of the Ghanaian people. Their enthusiasm is unmatched. You can feel it in every conversation, brimming with passion and conviction, but it's especially apparent when music starts playing. Ghanaians are phenomenal dancers. Going out in Ghana is always an absolute joy because everyone fully immerses themselves in the rhythm, showcasing their best moves. The energy is so infectious that you can't help but join in. I even learned several dances to popular Afrobeats songs and still listen to my Ghana playlist daily.

Discover

The IAESTE team was incredibly supportive and always ensured we were doing well. If you encounter any issues, you can count on them to assist and take care of you. The weekend trips were a fantastic way to explore the country safely within a group, providing an authentic glimpse into the lives of the local people. I made many new friends during my stay and would love to return one day!

Moses' internship in Germany

Mobile Robotics Intern at the
Merseburg University of Applied Sciences

This transformative experience not only advanced my career but also my cultural understanding and my global network.



Kenya



Germany



“

During his internship, Moses worked on advanced robotics projects, including teleoperation, navigation, and sensor integration, using the TurtleBot3 Robotics Kit and AuRa—an autonomous cargo bike developed in collaboration with Otto-von-Guericke University Magdeburg.

In addition to gaining technical expertise, the internship offered a rich cultural experience. Moses collaborated with colleagues from Germany, Ghana, Bulgaria, and China, which provided valuable insights into diverse perspectives. He also experienced German efficiency and long summer daylight hours firsthand. Through IAESTE, Moses traveled across Europe, visiting cities such as Munich, Prague, Vienna, and Rome, while building a network of international contacts.

The internship also gave Moses an opportunity to represent Dedan Kimathi University of Technology. He actively promoted internships in Kenya and challenged stereotypes about Africa. This transformative experience not only advanced his career but also deepened his cultural understanding and expanded his global network.



Daniel's internship in Germany

Infinity GmbH

Thank you, IAESTE, for making dreams like mine a reality!

 Colombia

 Germany



Participating in an international internship through IAESTE has truly been a transformative experience for me, both professionally and personally. I had the privilege of working at Infinity GmbH for the RefresherBoxx brand, where I honed my skills, contributed to innovative projects, and gained invaluable insights into the global work environment.

One of the highlights of my journey was representing RefresherBoxx at the United Nations in Bonn, where I delivered a pitch about this groundbreaking product. The opportunity to showcase a solution with the potential to change the world on such a global platform was an unforgettable moment and a true milestone in my career.

This experience has opened my eyes to endless possibilities, built lifelong connections, and shaped me into a better version of myself. I encourage every student to embrace this opportunity, step out of their comfort zone, and explore what IAESTE has to offer. You never know how far it can take you!

Alexander's internship in Switzerland

R&D Intern at Hitachi Energy

Working with skilled engineers broadened my perspective, helping me discover my passion.



Bolivia



Switzerland



“

Work

I worked as an Research and Development (R&D) Intern in the Gas Circuit Breakers Team at Hitachi Energy in Switzerland, validating an in-house MATLAB tool for contact erosion calculations and analyzing high-voltage circuit breaker test results. In the final two months, I also worked on CAD design in CREO and 3D field calculations in COMSOL, while supporting high-voltage lab experiments. Despite the initial challenge of working abroad with highly experienced scientists, their guidance was instrumental in my growth.

Experience

Finding a room in Switzerland can be tough, but I was lucky to be offered a studio during my interview. The company provided intern housing near work, just a 10-minute bus ride away. While the canteen was available, I preferred cooking to save money, though I happily splurged on Swiss chocolate. I worked Monday to Friday, occasionally from home, and joined IAESTE's weekly Zurich meetups on Thursdays. Weekends were for adventure-hiking with IAESTE friends, colleagues, or even new people I met along the way.

Discover

Moving abroad for my first international internship was a tough decision, but Switzerland turned out to be the perfect choice. Working with skilled engineers broadened my perspective, helping me discover my passion and clarify my future studies. Beyond work, Switzerland's beauty exceeded all expectations. I'm deeply grateful to IAESTE, my employer, and friends for this life-changing experience - I can't wait to return. Vielen Dank!



Nour's internship in Lebanon

American University of Beirut

I am forever grateful to IAESTE Tunisia and IAESTE Lebanon for making this unforgettable experience possible.



Tunisia



Lebanon

Work

My internship in Lebanon was an exciting opportunity to work on a TinyML project: Voice Controlling LEDs Using Edge Impulse. I developed a machine learning model capable of recognizing voice commands and deploying them on an embedded system to control LEDs. This project allowed me to explore speech recognition, embedded AI, and real-time inference on low-power devices. With the guidance of my supportive and flexible employers, I was able to experiment, optimize my model, and gain hands-on experience in Edge Impulse and TinyML deployment. This experience deepened my passion for embedded AI and reinforced my skills in building intelligent, real-time systems.

Experience

Beyond the technical aspect, this exchange was an incredible social experience. I found myself immersed in a diverse and international community, meeting people from different backgrounds who quickly became dear friends. The lively campus where I lived and worked left a lasting impression on me—it was a place full of energy, learning, and unforgettable moments. The warmth and hospitality of the people I met made Lebanon feel like a second home.

Discover

Lebanon is a country full of surprises, and every day felt like an adventure. From exploring the breathtaking Jeitta Grotto to wandering through the charming streets of Batroun and experiencing the vibrant nights of Jbeil, I was in constant awe of its beauty. Each hidden gem I discovered deepened my appreciation for this incredible place. This journey taught me that the best experiences come when you step out of your comfort zone and embrace the unknown.

I am forever grateful to IAESTE Tunisia and IAESTE Lebanon for making this unforgettable experience possible.

IAESTE internship hosts

“



4traffic GmbH

📍 Germany

Henric Breuer, CEO

At 4traffic GmbH, we are committed to fostering international collaboration and creating opportunities for students from around the globe to gain practical experience. Through the IAESTE programme, we have had the pleasure of hosting students from diverse countries, including Jordan, the United Arab Emirates, Tajikistan, and Poland.

Recently, two students joined us in Aachen to work on projects related to transportation data analysis and software development. Their tasks involved optimizing algorithms for traffic prediction and contributing to the development of our smart mobility platform. Their contributions not only improved our systems but also helped expand the international perspective of our team.

We are proud of our collaboration with IAESTE, as it brings fresh ideas, energy, and a global mindset to our company. These partnerships enrich both our projects and the professional journeys of the students involved.

“



Biometrika

📍 Ecuador

Francisco Fuentes, CIO

For over 20 years, the Ecuadorian company Biometrika has supported IAESTE, by hosting interns from more than 12 countries. The collaboration between local and international professionals has led to innovations that enable companies to reach new heights.

In 2018, Biometrika's technical team, in partnership with IAESTE, embarked on a meticulous technological research process, exploring the concept of the "Internet of Things". This collaboration resulted in the creation of Daniela, a robot prototype focused on Smart Time Management, a concept which shows how companies can reduce costs in human resource management and streamline their processes. Today, Daniela represents a significant technological breakthrough in Ecuador. Its development, which began by bringing together knowledge and brilliant minds, continues to advance due to the ongoing fusion of cultures and continuous research, ensuring the robot's evolution.



TDK Electronics GmbH & Co OG

 Austria

Mag. Christian Oswald, Human Resources

The Deutschlandsberg site in Austria is the headquarter of the Piezo and Protection Devices business group and stands for competence not only in electroceramics but also in robotics and Industry 4.0. Over the past years, we have welcomed talented students from various countries, each bringing unique skills and fresh perspectives to our projects.

Our IAESTE interns are primarily working in our corporate research department, where they gain valuable experience in conducting various projects, teamwork, and communicating with international personnel in an industrial environment. Our team has greatly benefited from the cultural exchange and the interns' enthusiasm. We look forward to continuing this collaboration and supporting the professional growth of young talents through IAESTE internships.



Tokyo University of Science

 Japan

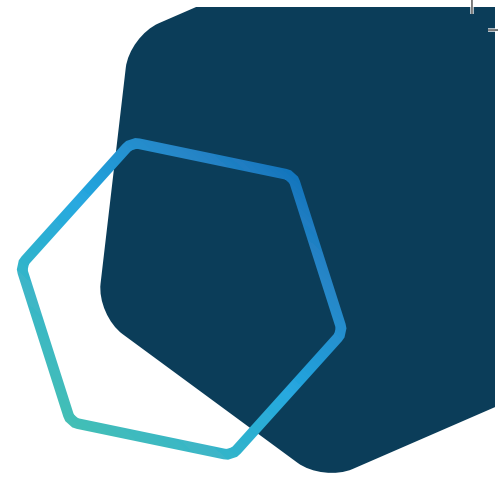
Prof. Makoto Yamamoto, Tokyo University of Science

Our laboratory hosts students from all over the world, especially from Europe, every year. The interns are highly skilled technically and help to advance the research in our laboratory. The intern's presence had a positive impact on the overall atmosphere in the lab and motivated other students as well.

A positive and collaborative environment can enhance productivity and creativity. The cultural exchange aspect is an added bonus. Learning from people with different backgrounds and perspectives can enrich the overall learning experience and broaden everyone's horizons.

Overall, the intern made a significant contribution to our laboratory's activities, both in terms of research and the overall atmosphere.

IAESTE universities



Purdue University

 United States

Heather Fabriès, *IAESTE Manager,*
Office of Professional Practice, Purdue University

As a member of Purdue University's Office of Professional Practice, I am thrilled to highlight our partnership with IAESTE. Now in its third year, this collaboration has greatly expanded access to summer research opportunities in our labs for talented students worldwide. IAESTE has been pivotal in helping our GEARE students secure international internships that directly align with their technical disciplines. This programme enriches the academic and professional experiences of our students while also reinforcing Purdue's standing as a globally engaged institution. We are excited about the future and confident that IAESTE will continue to be a valuable tool in fostering worldwide internships and collaboration.



Fourah Bay College

 Sierra Leone

John D. Cooper, Ph.D. *Director of Policy & Research*
Ministry of Mines & Mineral Resources

Fourah Bay College is excited to rejoin IAESTE, reaffirming its commitment to fostering global academic and professional opportunities for its students. By reestablishing this partnership, the college aims to provide students with practical international exposure, enhance their technical skills, and build a network of global professionals. Looking ahead, Fourah Bay College aspires to leverage IAESTE to empower its students to become competitive in the global job market while contributing to Sierra Leone's human capital development.



Medical University of Lodz

Poland

Prof. Agnieszka Piastowska - Ciesielska, DSc, PhD,
Vice-Rector for Science

The IAESTE Exchange Programme has been present at our university since 2012. The Medical University of Łódź is the only medical university participating in this programme, as we firmly believe that the STEM fields complement the broad spectrum of medical sciences. Since joining the programme, we have successfully sent and received over 200 students. We offer valuable experiences for students in biomedical sciences, pharmacy, and medical biotechnology.

As the Head of the Department of Cell Cultures and Genomic Analysis, I am proud to say that every year we are delighted to host international students through the IAESTE programme. Their involvement in our projects provides them with the opportunity to gain new skills and embrace new challenges.

I deeply believe that technical advancements are integral to progress in medicine, and these fields are strongly interconnected.



The University of Jordan

Jordan

Dr. Osaid Matar, Professor & National Secretary of IAESTE Jordan,
Vice Dean for Training and Alumni Affairs, School of Engineering

Since 1978, IAESTE, represented in Jordan by The University of Jordan (UJ), has been transforming students' futures through life-changing international internships. For over 40 years, UJ, in collaboration with IAESTE, has facilitated the exchange of 2020 outgoing students and welcomed 3409 international interns, creating a dynamic hub for global talent and innovation. These internships offer valuable hands-on experience, immersion in diverse work environments, and the chance to develop essential skills like creativity, adaptability, and leadership. By bridging local and international talent, IAESTE Jordan has been a driving force in fostering cross-cultural collaboration, strengthening academia-industry connections, and unlocking career opportunities for students across Jordan. This journey has not only empowered students but has also contributed to a more interconnected, skilled, and globally competitive workforce. The world is your workplace - explore it with IAESTE!

IAESTE volunteers



Paschal in Canada

A life-changing experience



“

It all began during my studies at university. In my second year, I decided to join the local IAESTE committee — a decision that opened doors to opportunities I never could have imagined.

As a member of the executive committee, I participated in weekly meetings, coordinated events, and sourced job offers for international students. These experiences taught me the value of teamwork, leadership, and cross-cultural collaboration, igniting a passion for making a difference in the lives of others.

When I relocated to Canada, my enthusiasm for IAESTE remained unwavering. I joined IAESTE Canada as a volunteer, where I found myself sharing my story with students and inspiring them to explore the unique opportunities IAESTE provides. The Canadian IAESTE committee welcomed me with open arms, giving me the chance to actively participate in their meetings and initiatives, further deepening my connection to this incredible organization.

IAESTE has truly been a life-changing experience, connecting me to international friendships and a global professional network. It has taught me invaluable lessons in cultural diversity, adaptability, and the importance of stepping out of my comfort zone.

IAESTE India

A student-run, self-funded organisation that thrives on the energy and passion of its youth-led structure.



“

With four Local Committees (Manipal, JECRC, KU, and MUJ), each entirely student-managed, IAESTE India thrives with 300–400 active volunteers annually and over 500 applicants per committee. These dedicated volunteers plan and execute all events, from welcoming interns to organizing flagship activities, fostering creativity and leadership among students aged 17–22.

The organization's hierarchical structure allows freshmen to grow into senior roles, ensuring continuity and introducing fresh perspectives while building essential soft skills. This decentralized approach empowers students to take ownership of their responsibilities, fostering innovation and sustaining IAESTE India's dynamic and impactful operations.

Volunteers connect personally with incoming interns, offering cultural immersion and forging lasting friendships that often extend beyond the internship period. This unique blend of professional development and cultural exchange makes IAESTE India highly sought after by students and a standout chapter for international interns.





Vaëa in France

To me, IAESTE it's about empowering students to discover the world, but mostly themselves, through international experiences.



When I first joined IAESTE in 2017 as a new engineering student, I had no idea just how much this decision would transform my life. At that time, IAESTE France was just finding its footing, each step was filled with discovery, navigating an international environment rich in both challenges and new possibilities. Little did I know it would become the start of an incredible journey, shaping me both personally and professionally.

Becoming IAESTE France's president in 2020 was intense yet deeply rewarding. With just four members left during the pandemic, we hired our first intern who was my age! Realizing I was capable of mentoring her filled me with confidence and hope that I could lead and empower our future volunteers. Becoming National Secretary of IAESTE France in 2023 deepened my appreciation for the wonderful spirit of mutual support and collaboration between IAESTE countries.

Now, serving also as Connect Region Forum Coordinator, I organize forums that help volunteers overcome challenges together: it's my way of giving back the guidance and support that shaped me.

Every time we help students secure their dream internship, find housing, or navigate the (very) complicated French administration, I'm reminded of the human connections at the heart of our work. All of this confirms that joining IAESTE was one of the best decisions of my life.

Growth of IAESTE

Enhancing the IAESTE network

IAESTE was founded to build bridges between countries, communities and individuals and this goal is still relevant today. That is why we are working hard to expand our network of IAESTE offices and to find new ways to cooperate with other relevant stakeholders including the United Nations agencies, international organisations, companies, NGOs, the private sector, and universities.

In the last five years, we witnessed significant growth in our network, welcoming 20 new committees from 16 countries, with 6 countries re-joining our network. Of these, 14 countries joined from Africa, adding 20 new national committees.

IAESTE regularly participates in key events aimed at internationalisation of higher education, such as the conferences of NAFSA (Association of International Educators) and EAIE (European Association for International Education).

IAESTE strengthens its existing network by organising international, regional and national events, such as Annual Conferences, Central European Conventions and training activities for new volunteers. During these events, IAESTE members meet to shape the future of the association, learn from each other and also have fun.





IAESTE is more than just internships.

It's a global network that brings together people from diverse cultures and backgrounds, fostering international understanding through skills and collaboration.

But it's not just about work—it's about friendships, communities, and experiences that stay with you for a lifetime.

IAESTE isn't just a programme; it's a life-changing journey.



IAESTE

Work. Experience. Discover.



RENTICE
RAMME

iaeste.org